

# LEAH PETTWAY

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## SUMMARY

Recent Geography graduate (GIS Emphasis) with hands-on experience in remote sensing analysis, geospatial data collection, and field research. Skilled in ArcGIS, Google Earth Engine, R, and Python, with two years of independent research analyzing land cover change and direct field experience collecting and managing species and habitat data. Seeking to support Yosemite National Park's Enterprise GIS through data management, geospatial analysis, and field-based data collection.

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## EDUCATION

**University of California, Santa Barbara** June 2026

*Bachelor of Arts, Geography (GIS Emphasis)*

*Bachelor of Science, Environmental Studies | GPA: 3.6*

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## GIS & RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

**Undergraduate Research Assistant — Coastal Wetlands Impervious Surface Analysis** — *University of California, Santa Barbara* 2024 – 2026

- Conducted an independent, two-year research project tied to a graduate student's research, analyzing impervious surface cover trends around California coastal wetlands.
- Processed and analyzed multi-temporal satellite imagery in Google Earth Engine to detect land cover change over time.
- Used R to clean, analyze, and visualize geospatial datasets, and applied ArcGIS for spatial analysis and cartographic output.
- Wrote Python scripts to automate repetitive data processing tasks, improving workflow efficiency and reproducibility.
- Evaluated the impact of land use change on coastal wetland ecosystems, translating spatial analysis into research findings.

**Research Intern** — *Cheadle Center for Biodiversity and Ecological Restoration* April 2024 – Present

- Collected and verified species occurrence and habitat conditions data across field sites using transect sampling methods.
- Used iNaturalist to identify and confirm species observed in the field, supporting accurate biodiversity records.
- Entered and maintained field observation data in a shared public database, ensuring accuracy and consistency.
- Used Excel to organize, track, and analyze data collected across multiple research sites.
- Set up and maintained field equipment across two research sites.

**Restoration Intern** — *Homeowners Association* September 2023 – December 2023

- Performed hands-on land restoration fieldwork as part of a small team in a remote outdoor setting.
- Reduced invasive plant coverage by 40% through consistent, detail-oriented field monitoring and treatment.

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## ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

**Conference Desk Attendant** — *UCSB Conference & Hospitality Services* June 2024 – Sept. 2024, June 2025 - Sept. 2025

- Managed daily check-in/check-out for groups of 50+ attendees and maintained organized, accurate front desk records.
- Served as the first point of contact for guest questions, resolving issues promptly and professionally.

**Cashier & Delivery Driver** — *Jimmy John's* June 2023 – September 2023

- Processed customer transactions accurately and provided efficient service in a fast-paced environment.

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## SKILLS

GIS & Remote Sensing: ArcGIS, Google Earth Engine, geospatial/spatial analysis, cartographic mapping, land cover change detection

Programming & Data: Python, R, Microsoft Excel

Field Methods: Transect sampling, species identification (iNaturalist), field data collection, equipment setup/maintenance

Other: Teamwork, attention to detail, customer service

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## ACTIVITIES

Social Chair, UCSB Women's Rugby Club | Alum, UCSB Bren Fellows